



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 4: Thinking, Language, Reasoning and Judgment

Reasoning, Judgment and Bias

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

Version: 2026

Reasoning

Reasoning is drawing conclusions from information. Deductive reasoning moves from general rules to specific cases. Inductive reasoning builds general ideas from specific examples. Both appear in essays, research methods, and everyday claims on social media.

Judgment and Bias

Judgment is evaluating options or people. Common risks include relying on the first example that comes to mind, favouring information that fits what you already believe, and overconfidence after limited study. Noticing bias is a skill for group work, clinical settings later, and reading news.

Better Thinking Habits

Ask what the claim is and what the evidence is. Consider an alternative explanation. Slow down on important decisions. Write the problem in one clear sentence before solving it.

Reflect: Which habit will you practise this week: checking evidence, considering an alternative, or writing the problem clearly?

Closing

Module 4 is complete. Module 5 covers motivation, emotion, and perception.